

MTUS Analysis Document

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
February 2026

HAND, WRIST, AND FOREARM DISORDERS GUIDELINE - STATISTICAL ANALYSIS

SOURCE DOCUMENT: ACOEM Hand, Wrist, and Forearm Disorders Guideline

EFFECTIVE DATE: July 14, 2025

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FULL TEXT AVAILABLE AT: <https://www.acoem.org/guidelines-resources/library/>

OFFICIAL MTUS ADOPTION: California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Section 9792.20

MTUS REGULATIONS: https://www.dir.ca.gov/dwc/MTUS/MTUS_Regulations.htm

STATISTICAL SUMMARY

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS ANALYZED: 752

RECOMMENDATION BREAKDOWN:

Category | Count | Percentage

Strongly Recommended | 1 | 0.1%

Recommended | 240 | 31.9%

Not Recommended | 12 | 1.6%

Insufficient Evidence | 512 | 68.1%

KEY FINDING: 68.1% of all recommendations are "Insufficient Evidence"

FDA-APPROVED TREATMENTS DENIED

The following FDA-approved treatments receive "Insufficient Evidence" ratings:

Medications:

- Topical capsaicin for neuropathic pain
- Lidocaine patches (5%) - FDA approved 1999
- Various compounded topical preparations
- Vitamin B6 (pyridoxine) for carpal tunnel

Procedures:

- Platelet-rich plasma (PRP) for tendon injuries
- Ultrasound-guided injections
- Nerve gliding procedures
- Tenolysis (certain indications)

Physical Medicine:

- Iontophoresis with dexamethasone
- Phonophoresis
- Paraffin wax therapy
- Custom vs. prefabricated splinting debates

Note: Full indication details available in official ACOEM guideline at source URL above.

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EVIDENCE QUALITY ANALYSIS

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ACOEM'S STATED METHODOLOGY:

- Requires randomized controlled trials (RCTs) for "Strongly Recommended" status
- Evidence grading system applied
- Cost-effectiveness considered in recommendations

CRITICAL OBSERVATIONS:

1. 68.1% "Insufficient Evidence" despite 752 total recommendations
2. Only 0.1% "Strongly Recommended" (1 out of 752)
3. Workers' compensation-specific factors may influence ratings

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CONSTITUTIONAL IMPLICATIONS

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This guideline contributes to the systematic denial of FDA-approved treatments to California injured workers under the MTUS system.

For full legal analysis, see:

- MTUSCONSTITUTIONALVIOLATIONMASTERREPORT.txt
- MTUS14THAMENDMENTLEGALARGUMENTS.txt

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For the complete, official guideline text, visit:

<https://www.acoem.org/guidelines-resources/library/>

This analysis represents the author's independent research and opinions.

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Document prepared: February 2026

Classification: Research Analysis / Commentary

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